Clear Sample Data Guide

Remove the 8 sample transactions, keep every formula, and start fresh safely. Read this BEFORE entering your own margin transactions.

THE GOLDEN RULE

NEVER right-click and choose “Delete rows,” and never delete rows from the Margin Portfolio, Margin Interest, Dividend Tracker or Tax Dashboard tabs. That breaks the ACB and tax formulas.

ALWAYS press the Delete key on the selected cells in the Transaction Log. It clears the values and keeps every formula intact; every other tab resets to $0.00 on its own.

8 STEPS TO CLEAR THE SAMPLE DATA

1. **Make your copy first**
   Click your template link, click “Make a copy,” and rename it “Margin Tracker 2026 — [Your Name].” Always work from YOUR copy in Google Drive.

2. **Name a safety version**
   File → Version history → Name current version → “Before clearing sample data.” You can always go back to it.

3. **Open the Transaction Log**
   Click the Transaction Log tab. Row 3 holds the column headers; row 4 is the first sample transaction.

4. **Select all sample rows**
   Click cell A4, then press Ctrl+Shift+End (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+End (Mac). This selects all 8 sample rows.

5. **Press the Delete key only**
   Press Delete. Not Backspace, and not right-click → Delete rows. The values clear and every formula stays in place.

6. **Check the reset**
   The Main Dashboard, Margin Portfolio, Margin Interest and Tax Dashboard should all show $0.00.

7. **Update Settings & Goals**
   Fill in the amber cells: your name, the Active Year, your margin rate, the balance borrowed and your goals.

8 **Enter your first transaction**
Back in the Transaction Log, start at row 4 with Account = Margin. Every tab updates instantly.

TAB-BY-TAB REFERENCE

Tab	Has sample data?	What to do
Transaction Log	YES: rows 4 and below	Press Delete on rows 4+ only. Never delete the rows themselves.
Settings & Goals	YES: sample values	Replace the amber cells with your own rate, balance and goals.
Main Dashboard, Margin Portfolio	No, formulas only	Do nothing. They reset when the Transaction Log is cleared.
Margin Interest, Dividend Tracker	No, formulas only	Do nothing. They calculate on their own.
Tax Dashboard, Analysis & Reco	No, formulas only	Do nothing. They calculate on their own.
Start Here	No, instructions	Read once. No changes needed.

Something went wrong? File → Version history → See version history, pick the version you named in step 2, and click “Restore this version.”